



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cape Verde: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-26 · 18 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

The month's substance was fiscal and statistical rather than technical. [Parliament approved a rectificative budget for 2026 on 31 July at CVE 103,888 million, against the CVE 95,675 million it had voted, naming connectivity among the priorities of the reorganisation without giving a digital figure.](#) On the same day the Prime Minister told Parliament that the national statistics institute had produced falsified data and ordered an independent evaluation of it; the institute's board rejected the allegations three days later and offered to host any external review ([both accounts](#)). One system entered service: a national pharmaceutical market monitoring platform launched on 29 July, tracking the medicines circuit in real time and integrated with the customs system.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

A [strategic consultation on the national digital transformation agenda was convened in Praia on 6 August](#), seating public administration, private sector, academia and named specialists, whose contributions are to feed a national diagnosis and the agenda's priorities. Its stated scope runs from interoperability of the public administration to digital inclusion, data protection and cybersecurity. No draft, title, adoption date or budget is held, and nothing connects it to the governance framework whose terms of reference the finance ministry issued in 2025.

Legislation and regulation

The regulator [opened a public consultation on licensing, spectrum use, frequency coordination, user protection, network security and emergency communications for satellite operators, with submissions to 31 August](#). It is a direct response to the satellite service launched in the archipelago in December 2024, and is distinct from the general-authorisation regime under which that service was licensed. No draft text or adoption date is published.

Standards

The Prime Minister told Parliament during the State of the Nation debate on 31 July 2026 that the statistics institute had produced falsified data, and announced an independent evaluation to establish alleged interference and manipulation. On 3 August the institute's board rejected the allegations clearly, firmly and categorically, and said it was available to receive any external evaluation mission or peer review, undertaking to supply all technical documentation ([both accounts](#)). Nothing is established about the evaluation's terms of reference, who conducts it, when it reports, or whether its findings will be published. The dispute is not new — anonymous technicians raised it in August 2025 and the institute rejected it in September 2025 — and the two accounts remain unreconciled.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

Parliament [approved the rectificative budget for 2026 on 31 July at CVE 103,888 million against a voted CVE 95,675 million](#) and a projected execution of CVE 104,011 million; it does not disclose a digital figure, though connectivity is named among the priorities of the reorganisation. The act had not appeared in the official gazette at 4 August, so the revised organic table that would show whether the digital ministry's reprogrammed position is ratified or reversed is not available. Cape Verde passed no rectificative budget for 2025, so that year's revised position was administrative rather than statutory.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

No new connectivity measurement was published in the window, and the regulator's market series still stops at the second quarter of 2025 ([regulator indicators](#)).

The continental frame moved instead. On 24 July 2026 the African Union development agency launched a Programme for African Developing Island Economies at a ministerial segment in Abidjan, covering Cape Verde and six other island states on a 2026-2031 roadmap organised on six pillars including connectivity, with digital public infrastructure and artificial intelligence named as accelerators. No Cape Verde-specific commitment, allocation or project is named in it.

Cybersecurity

The surveillance programme moved to a third phase on foreign money. China [made about EUR 9.3m available as non-reimbursable assistance for phase three of the Cidade Segura project](#), the implementation agreement signed in the week to 15 August by the interior minister and the Chinese ambassador at the National Police Command Centre in Praia, and stated as reinforcing the technological and operational capacity of the security forces and supporting criminal investigation. [Phase three covers command centres, data centres and wireless base stations at Assomada, Tarrafal de Santiago and Porto Novo, and expanded video surveillance in Praia and Mindelo](#). No camera count, retention rule, data-protection authorisation or oversight arrangement is published for this phase or the two before it.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identity stack is unchanged and its next step is undated. The national identity card [keeps its design and legal basis and is now produced domestically and renewable online through the justice portal](#), and the mobile digital key [rests on implementing rules of 2022](#) with no activation count and no coverage rate held from any date. The authentication platform was [presented at the continental identity meeting with a stated next phase of consolidating existing databases, expanding identity-enabled services and finding long-term financing models](#) — carrying no date, instrument or budget line. The restriction binding the mobile credential to prior card activation is undated on the government page and may no longer hold.

Sectoral management information systems

The independent health regulator launched a pharmaceutical market monitoring system on 29 July 2026, tracking the national medicines circuit in real time, forecasting stock-outs and triggering replenishment or redistribution across the archipelago, and integrated with the customs system to detect illegal imports. The regulator states it will support development of electronic prescribing and feed its medicines-authorisation function. No cost, vendor, coverage figure or baseline stock-out rate was published, and the wiki holds no first-party document for it, only a wire report a week after launch.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A municipal council [presented a services platform it plans to put into public presentation in October 2026 and into operation by the end of that year, opening with 17 services - applications submitted, cases tracked in real time, payments made and official documents received in digital form with legal validity](#). It is funded by the UN joint office, whose resident coordinator asked the council to consider integrating further procedures in a second phase, while the minister for family, inclusion, social development and labour argued for keeping and improving traditional counter services for those still facing difficulties with digital access, and for replicating the model in the other municipalities if it succeeds.

Technology

AI

The Health Minister proposed at a World Health Organization conference in Lisbon on 15 July that Cape Verde serve as a lusophone laboratory for artificial intelligence in health, hosting pilot projects integrating it with telemedicine, and called for cooperation on skills, infrastructure, interoperability and an ethical and regulatory framework. No pilot, partner, budget or instrument follows from it.

ICT Industry

The technology park's second phase went to open international tender on 29 July 2026, for supply and installation of facilities equipment and training, procured by the special projects unit in the Ministry of Finance under an African Development Bank loan. [Bids close on 15 September 2026, with a bid security of EUR 25,000](#) and beneficial-ownership disclosure required of the successful bidder. The contract value is not published, so the tender fixes scope and timetable without sizing them.

Innovation ecosystem

The innovation record moved to the extent that two institutions said they intend to work together. The national university and the economy ministry [are projecting a partnership on innovation, entrepreneurship and employment](#). Projected is the operative word: no scope, funding or programme accompanies it, and nothing here is yet an instrument the base can track.

Data

National statistics

The statistical record produced the month's other development, and it was an absence made public. The World Bank presented a poverty estimate in Praia on 14 July microsimulated from the 2015 household survey, because the survey fielded from December 2022 has published no definitive results more than three years on. The statistics institute has stated that an under-reporting of food expenditure was identified and corrected and that a new fully digital survey was planned for July 2026; no source records that survey starting.

Geopolitics

China activities

On 29 July the Prime Minister and Finance Minister received a Huawei delegation, reviewed what the government describes as a strategic ICT partnership and were introduced to a new country representative. No agreement, project, sum or timetable was named; what the account records is access and continuity rather than a transaction. The last dated Chinese technology commitment the wiki holds for Cape Verde closed in 2021.

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